
HPL Tool *Ultimate*

Instrukcja obsługi / User manual

Dwujęzyczny przewodnik po programie dla Windows. Część polska znajduje się u góry dokumentu, pełna wersja angielska poniżej.

System

Windows 10 / 11 (64-bit)

Wydanie

v3.23 17.09.2026

Postać

jeden plik .exe, bez instalacji

Licencja

kod aktywacyjny na jeden komputer

Zasada oznaczeń: **ADMIN** oznacza funkcję, która działa tylko po uruchomieniu programu jako administrator. **PIN** oznacza funkcję, przed którą program pyta o PIN.

Wydanie dokumentu: ta instrukcja opisuje **HPL Tool Ultimate v3.23** z 17.09.2026, w wersji z aktywacją kodem. Okno aktywacji jest w języku angielskim. Język samego programu przełącza się w prawym górnym rogu okna — **PL** albo **EN**.

English user manual

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1. What the program is

HPL Tool Ultimate is a single `.exe` file for Windows that brings together, in one window, the things you would normally open several separate programs for: fast file search across the whole disk, network tools, a file server for the home network, small everyday utilities and scheduled shutdown.

The program **needs no installation**. It does not appear in the Start menu, creates no uninstall entries and scatters no files around the system. Everything it needs — the icon, the logo and the network-card vendor database — sits inside the `.exe` file.

Four tabs

Tab	What it is for
SEARCH	The file index and searching by name, size, date, extension or content. Duplicates, batch rename, the “what eats the disk” report. This is the default tab — it opens right after start.
NETWORK	Ping, DNS, network and port scanners, traceroute, traffic monitor, Wake on LAN, Wi-Fi, MAC change, the file server and the “why is there no internet” diagnostics.
TOOLS	Screenshots, clipboard history, notes, password generator, checksums, folder snapshot, startup manager, system report, firewall, TEMP cleaning, Keep Awake.
POWER	Shutdown, restart, hibernation, sleep and log off — now, in X minutes, at a given time or daily at a fixed hour. Restart to BIOS.

What the program does not do

- It does not search the cloud or network drives of other computers — it works on disks visible in the system.

- It is not an antivirus and not a data recovery tool.
- It does not send your files anywhere. The only internet connections it makes are: checking the public IP address (**MY DATA**), resolving the country of remote connections (an option you switch on yourself) and talking to the router when sharing through UPnP.

Working data is kept next to the .exe file. The index, notes, PIN, clipboard history and the remaining settings are written into the same folder the program sits in. Moving that folder to another disk or a USB stick takes them along — see chapter 3.

2. Program activation

The program needs a one-off activation on the computer it was started on. On the first start, instead of the main window, an activation window appears — in English, regardless of the system language.

HPL Tool Ultimate ver.3.23 — Activation

This copy is not activated.

To keep using the program you need to activate a licence for this computer.

1. Copy the request code below (button Copy code).
2. Send it to: `hplink.soft@proton.me`
3. Use this message subject: HPL Tool Ultimate - activation
4. Paste the activation code you receive and press Activate.

COMPUTER ID: **HPL-4C7A-91B3-E28D**

REQUEST CODE

`eyJwaWQiOiJIUEXUT09MVUxUIiwibWlkIjoIUFJaWUtMQUQtREVNTy1NQUNISU5FLU1ELTAwMDEi...`

ACTIVATION CODE

Copy code

Activate

Close program

1. Copy code

One click copies the whole request code to the clipboard.

2. Send it

Paste it into a message to `hplink.soft@proton.me`, subject `HPL Tool Ultimate - activation`.

3. Paste the code

Put the activation code you receive into the ACTIVATION CODE field.

4. Activate

The program confirms *Licence activated* and opens the main window.

The activation code is about 340 characters long and is a **signature bound to one computer**. Passed on to somebody else it will not work. Activation itself contacts no server — the codes travel by e-mail, so the program

needs no internet connection for it.

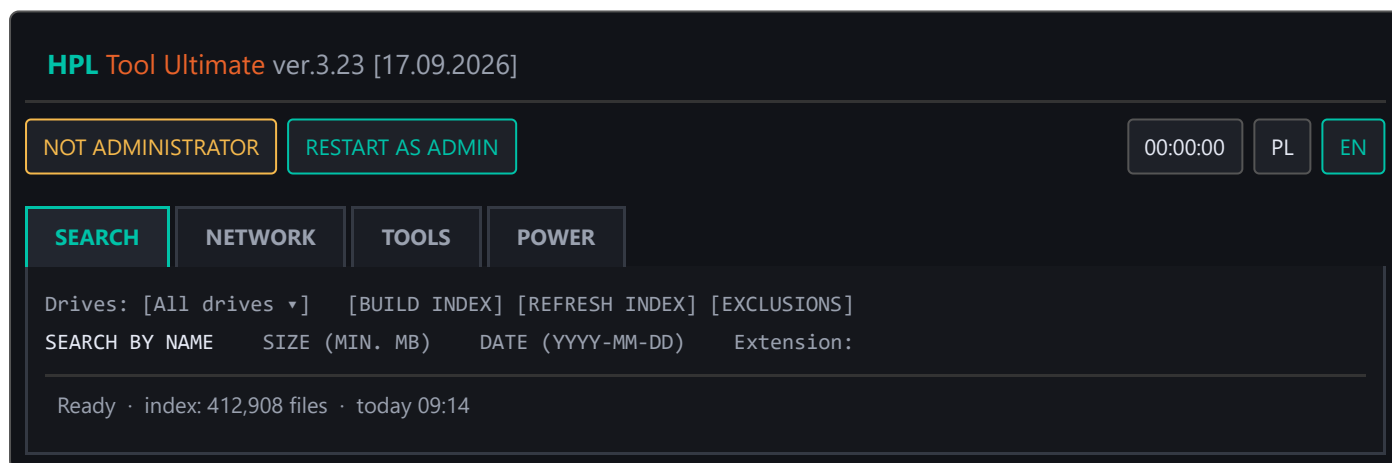
- **COMPUTER ID** in the form `HPL-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX` is the short identifier of the computer. It is worth including it in your message next to the request code — it makes the request easier to recognise.
- **Activation happens once.** On later starts the program goes straight to the main window.
- **The licence lives in the system, not next to the .exe file.** Moving the program to another folder or another disk of the same computer does not clear the activation.
- **Replacing the motherboard or the network card** changes the computer identifier — a new code is then needed.

Keep the activation code you receive. It stays valid indefinitely and will be useful if the system ever has to be reinstalled. A detailed, illustrated description of activation is in the separate file *Program activation — guide*.

“**This activation code is not valid for this computer**” usually means an incompletely copied code — a missing beginning or end, or the code broken while being pasted. Copy it again in one piece. The other possibility is a code issued for a different computer.

3. First start

After activation the program opens the main window on the **SEARCH** tab. The window has a fixed layout: a top bar, four tabs and a status bar at the bottom.



The top bar

- **The privileges marker.** The words *NOT ADMINISTRATOR* and the **RESTART AS ADMIN** button appear only when the program runs without elevated rights. Clicking restarts it, with the system asking for consent. Once running as administrator, that bar is gone.
- **The clock** in the middle counts down to a scheduled shutdown. With nothing scheduled it sits at `00:00:00`.
- **The PL / EN switch** in the right corner changes the language of the whole window at once, with no restart. After start the program is always in Polish.

What needs administrator rights. Without elevation these will not work: **DISABLE / ENABLE NETWORK, SET DNS, CHANGE MAC**, firewall rules (**BLOCK, UNBLOCK, BLOCK IN FIREWALL**), **RESTART TO BIOS** and reading process paths in the **CONNECTIONS** window. The rest of the program works normally.

The PIN

Some functions are protected by a four-digit PIN. **The default PIN is 0000** — it is worth changing it on the first run with the **CHANGE PIN** button in the TOOLS tab.

Asks for the PIN	Why
Closing the program	The program does not close from the X without a PIN — this protects a scheduled shutdown from being cancelled by accident.
CLEAN TEMP	Deletes temporary files and empties the Recycle Bin.
BLOCK / UNBLOCK in the firewall	Changes Windows firewall rules.
DISABLE NETWORK / ENABLE NETWORK	Cuts the computer off the network.
SET DNS	Changes the name servers of the network card.
RESTART TO BIOS	Restarts the computer straight into UEFI settings.
CHANGE PIN	Requires the old PIN before setting a new one.

Three wrong attempts lock the PIN for five minutes. During that time the program answers *Locked*. The counter resets once the PIN is entered correctly.

Where the program keeps its data

All working files are created **in the same folder that holds HPL Tool Ultimate.exe**. The program is portable: copying the whole folder to another disk or a USB stick takes the index, notes and settings along.

File	What it holds
index.json	The file index — the largest of these files, created by BUILD INDEX.
index_cfg.json	The list of folders skipped while indexing.
pin.dat	The PIN hash. Deleting the file restores the PIN 0000.
clipboard.json	Clipboard history together with pinned entries.

File	What it holds
notes.txt	The contents of the QUICK NOTES window.
wol.json	Saved Wake on LAN devices.
oplog.json	The file operation log — the source of UNDO.
ipinfo.json	Remembered names and vendors of devices from the network scanner.
autostart_backup.json	A copy of startup entries disabled from inside the program.
app_cfg.json	The remaining window and tool settings.

The licence is the exception. The activation state does not sit next to the .exe file but in the system — which is why moving the folder elsewhere on the same computer does not force another activation.

Do not keep the program in “Program Files”. Windows does not let an ordinary user write there, so the index and settings would have nowhere to go. Good places are a folder of your own, the desktop or a USB stick.

4. The file index

Searching by name, size, date and extension works on an **index** — a list of files made once, in advance. That is why results appear instantly instead of combing through the disk on every question.

Building the index

- 1. Choose the scope in the “Drives” field.** *All drives* takes every fixed disk. You can also pick a single drive or — with **SELECT FOLDER** — one particular directory.
- 2. Click BUILD INDEX.** The status bar shows how many files have been counted. Indexing a whole system disk usually takes a few minutes and produces an `index.json` of a few dozen megabytes.
- 3. Afterwards REFRESH INDEX is enough.** Refreshing adds the changes instead of rebuilding the list, so it is much quicker. With no index yet, the program says plainly: *Nothing to refresh — build the index first.*

The date of the last indexing sits on the status bar — *today, yesterday* or an actual date. With no index at all, the bar shows *no index*.

Exclusions

The **EXCLUSIONS** button opens the list of folders skipped while indexing. By default these are places where you would not look for your own files anyway: Windows system folders, temporary files, browser caches and update

folders. Skipping them shortens indexing and shrinks the index file.

- **Skip the listed folders (recommended)** — clearing this box indexes everything, system folders included.
- **SAVE** stores the list in `index_cfg.json`, **DEFAULTS** restores the factory set.

Changed exclusions take effect from the next indexing. An existing index does not change by itself — rebuild it after editing the list.

The index is a snapshot of the disk, not a live view. A file deleted after indexing will still appear in the results. The program notices this when opening it and says the file is gone — but the list does not refresh itself. After a big clean-up, click **REFRESH INDEX**.

5. Searching for files

The upper part of the SEARCH tab is four columns of criteria, each with its own button. The criteria can be used separately or combined.

SEARCH — criteria

SEARCH BY NAME

invoice

SEARCH BY NAME

SIZE (MIN. MB)

500

FILTER BY SIZE

DATE (YYYY-MM-DD)

2026-01-01

☒ This date and newer

SEARCH BY DATE

Extension: pdf

SEARCH BY EXTENSION

COMBINED SEARCH

In content: contract

SEARCH IN CONTENT

FILE DUPLICATES

Button	What it does
SEARCH BY NAME	Looks for the typed fragment in file names. Letter case does not matter. Typing <code>inv</code> finds <i>Invoice_2026.pdf</i> and <i>inventory.txt</i> .
FILTER BY SIZE	Shows files not smaller than the given number of megabytes. The quickest way to find what takes up space.
SEARCH BY DATE	The date in <code>YYYY-MM-DD</code> form. With <i>This date and newer</i> ticked it takes everything from that day onwards; unticked — that single day only.

Button	What it does
SEARCH BY EXTENSION	The extension alone, with or without the dot: pdf and .pdf work the same.
COMBINED SEARCH	Takes every filled field at once . Empty fields are ignored.
SEARCH IN CONTENT	Looks for a phrase inside text files — described in chapter 6.
FILE DUPLICATES	Finds repeated files across the whole index — described in chapter 6.

The header of the result list says which criterion filled it: *RESULTS — SIZE*, *RESULTS — DATE*, *RESULTS — EXTENSION*, *RESULTS — COMBINED* or *RESULTS — COMBINED + CONTENT*. Each file is listed with its size and modification date.

Searching by name, size, date and extension reads the index, so the answer is instant and puts no load on the disk. Content search has to open files one by one, so it takes longer and works on the folder you point at, not on the whole index.

No index means no results. With no index yet, the program says *Index not found! Build it first*. Click **BUILD INDEX** — see chapter 4.

Examples

- **Find every film larger than half a gigabyte.** Extension , size , the **COMBINED SEARCH** button.
- **What changed this week.** The date the week started, *This date and newer* ticked, the **SEARCH BY DATE** button.
- **Where did that invoice go.** Name , extension , **COMBINED SEARCH**.
- **The biggest files on the disk.** Size and **FILTER BY SIZE** — or go straight to **WHAT EATS THE DISK** from chapter 8.

6. Content search and duplicates

Searching in content

Type the phrase into the **In content** field, point at a folder with **SELECT FOLDER** and click **SEARCH IN CONTENT**. The program walks through the files in that folder and its subfolders and shows every hit together with **the line number and the beginning of that line**.

Limit	Value
File types	Text files only: <code>txt</code> , <code>log</code> , <code>ini</code> , <code>cfg</code> , <code>conf</code> , <code>csv</code> , <code>xml</code> , <code>json</code> , <code>md</code> , <code>py</code> , <code>bat</code> , <code>ps1</code> , <code>html</code> , <code>htm</code> , <code>css</code> , <code>js</code> , <code>sql</code> , <code>yaml</code> , <code>ym1</code> , <code>srt</code> , <code>nfo</code> , <code>reg</code> , <code>env</code> .
Largest file	20 MB. Bigger files are skipped so that one huge text archive does not stall the whole search.
Number of hits	1000. Once the limit is reached the program stops and adds (<i>hit limit</i>) to the summary.

This is not a document search. `.docx`, `.xlsx` and `.pdf` files are compressed or binary — the program does not open them and will not find a phrase inside them. Content search is for text files: configuration, logs, subtitles, code, CSV files.

A phrase together with other criteria. If, besides the phrase, you fill in the name, size, date or extension and click **COMBINED SEARCH**, the program first narrows the list down from the index and only then looks inside those files. With a very large number of candidates it asks whether to really read their contents — going through several thousand files takes time.

Duplicates

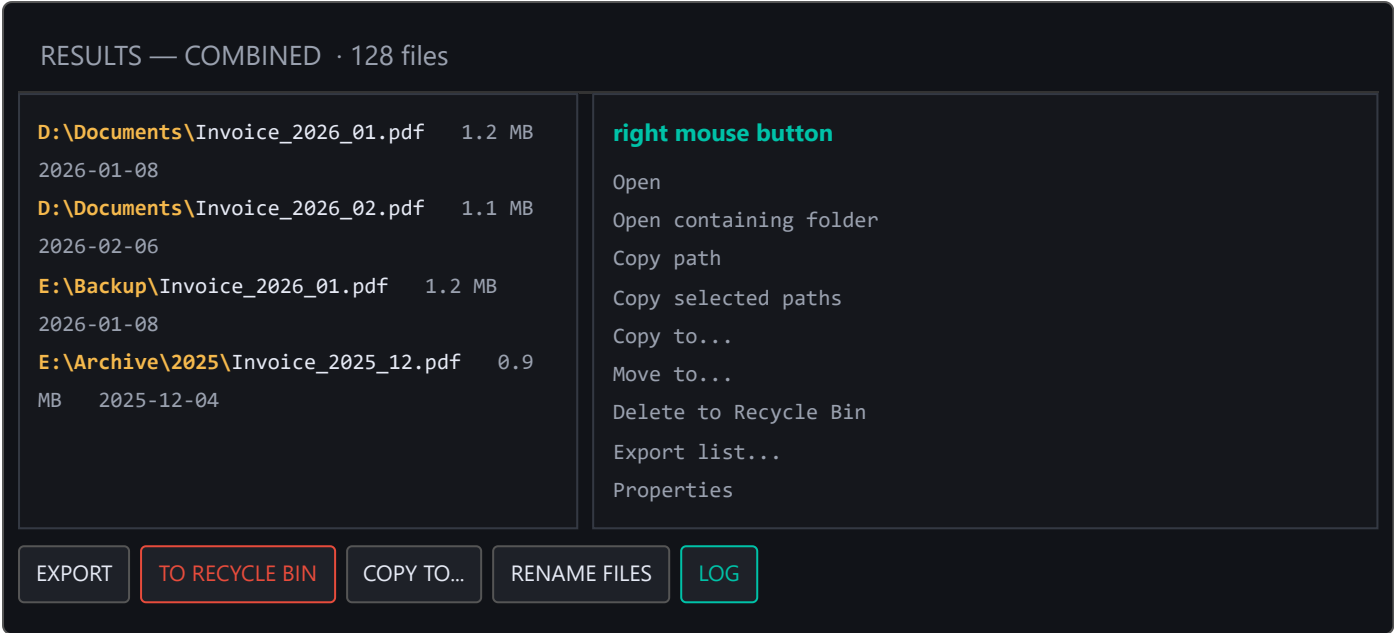
The **FILE DUPLICATES** button goes through the whole index and groups files that share **the same name and the same size**. The window shows the groups sorted from the largest files down, one group per section, with the path of every copy.

- **SELECT COPIES** ticks everything in each group **except the first file** — that is, what can be deleted while one copy stays.
- **DELETE TO RECYCLE BIN** moves the ticked files to the Recycle Bin, so a mistake can be undone.
- With more than 200 groups, the window shows the 200 largest and says so in the header.

A matching name and size is strong evidence, but not proof. The program does not compute checksums for every file on the disk — that would take hours. When you need certainty that two files are identical, compute their checksums with **CHECKSUM** from chapter 13.

7. What to do with results

The result list is not just for looking at. A single click selects, a double click opens the file, and the **right mouse button** opens a menu of operations.



Operation	Details
Open / double click	Opens the file in the program the system associates with it. If the file is gone, the program says so instead of opening an empty window.
Open containing folder	Opens Explorer with the file already selected.
Copy path	The full path of the chosen file goes to the clipboard. <i>Copy selected paths</i> does the same for the whole selection, one path per line.
Copy to... / Move to...	You pick a target folder; the program copies or moves all selected files and records the operation in the log.
Delete to Recycle Bin / TO RECYCLE BIN	Files go to the Windows Recycle Bin rather than disappearing for good — a deliberate decision so that a mistake can be reversed.
EXPORT	Saves the visible list to a <code>.csv</code> (semicolon) or <code>.txt</code> (tab) file — for a spreadsheet or a message.
Properties	Opens the system file properties window, the same one as in Explorer.

Batch rename

The **RENAME FILES** button opens a window in which one rule renames every file in the chosen folder.

- **Replace / with** — swaps a fragment of the name. *IMG_* to *Holiday_* turns `IMG_0041.jpg` into `Holiday_0041.jpg`.
- **Prefix** and **Suffix** — add text at the beginning or the end of the name, before the extension.
- **Number (001, 002...)** — appends a running number, in the order the list is displayed.

The **PREVIEW — OLD → NEW** box shows the result of the rule *before* it runs. Only **APPLY** actually renames anything. When a rule changes nothing, the program says *No changes to apply* and leaves the files alone.

Always read the preview. It is the only moment when you see the effect of the rule on every file at once. Renaming can also be undone — see below.

The operation log and UNDO

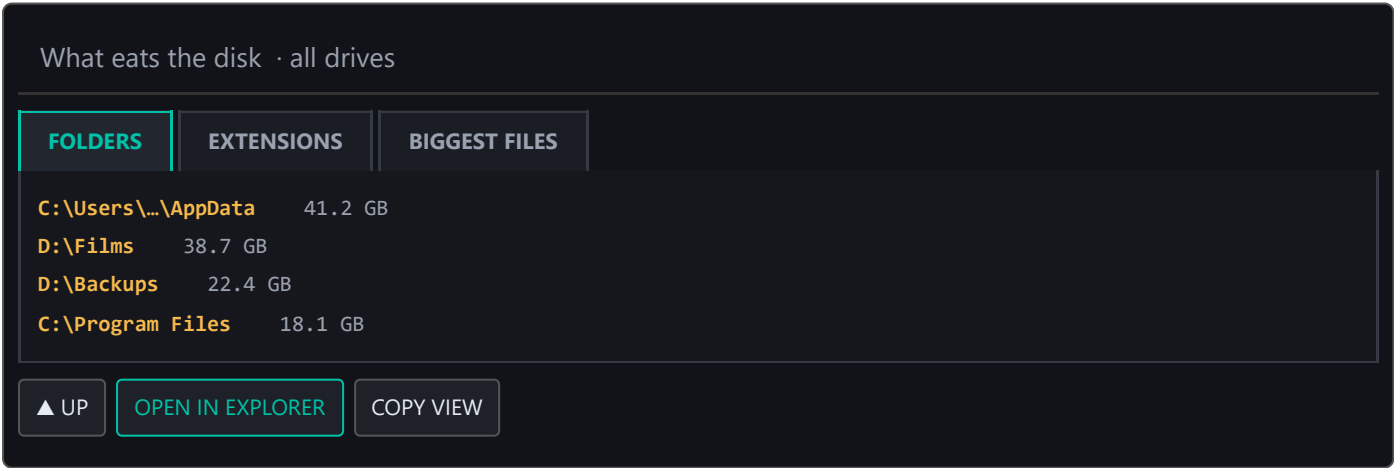
The **LOG** button in the TOOLS tab opens the record of everything the program did to files: copying, moving, deleting to the Recycle Bin and renaming. Every entry has a date, a kind and the number of files.

- **UNDO** reverses the selected operation — restores names, removes copies, brings a move back. The reversed entry stays on the list marked *undone*.
- **Kind** narrows the list down to one type of operation.
- **EXPORT TXT** saves the log to a file, **REFRESH** reloads it from the disk, **CLEAR** deletes the whole history after a confirmation.

Not everything can be undone. For entries that cannot be reversed — because the target file no longer exists or has changed meanwhile — the program says *This entry cannot be undone* rather than acting blindly. Deletion to the Recycle Bin is reversed through the Recycle Bin itself.

8. What eats the disk

The **WHAT EATS THE DISK** button computes usage **from the index** rather than by walking the disk again — which is why the report appears within seconds. The window has three tabs.



Tab	What it shows
FOLDERS	Directories from the heaviest down. A double click goes one level deeper, ▲ UP comes back. That is how you reach the exact place eating the disk.

Tab	What it shows
EXTENSIONS	How much space every file type takes altogether. It answers “is it films or backups”. Files without an extension go into the <i>(no extension)</i> row.
BIGGEST FILES	Individual files from the largest down, with their paths.

OPEN IN EXPLORER opens the selected folder or file, and **COPY VIEW** puts the whole visible list into the clipboard — handy when you want to send somebody the summary. The list can also be narrowed to a single drive.

The report is only as current as the index. After a big clean-up click **REFRESH INDEX** first, otherwise you will see the state from before the tidying.

Empty folders and 0-byte files

The **EMPTY / 0 B** button opens a separate window that searches **the folder you point at** (the **BROWSE** button, then **SCAN**) and shows two lists: *0-BYTE FILES* and *EMPTY FOLDERS*.

- **SELECT ALL** ticks both lists at once.
- **DELETE TO RECYCLE BIN** removes the ticked entries — here too, everything goes to the Recycle Bin.
- The scan can be stopped midway; the program then finishes with *Cancelled* and keeps whatever it found.

Empty does not always mean unnecessary. Some programs keep empty folders on purpose and recreate them at start. Look through the list before deleting everything at once — especially inside application folders.

9. NETWORK tab — basics

The top bar of the NETWORK tab selects the **network card** that every operation applies to: ping, DNS, MAC change, traffic monitor and enabling the network. The program fills the list with the cards visible in the system — usually Ethernet and Wi-Fi.

MY DATA

One button that answers the question “how am I actually connected”. The window gathers in one place what normally takes three different parts of the system:

Entry	What it means
Internet status	<i>OK</i> or <i>Offline</i> — whether the computer reaches the outside at all.
Router / DNS / internet ping	Three separate attempts. Together they show immediately which leg is broken: the router, the name server or the line itself.

Entry	What it means
Public IP	The address the internet sees you as. This is the only entry that needs a connection.
Local IP and subnet mask	The computer's address on the home network — the one you use when sharing files.
Computer MAC, computer name	For router configuration and for Wake on LAN.
Default gateway / router IP, router MAC	The address at which you open the router panel in a browser.
DNS servers	Which name servers are currently set.

COPY ALL puts the whole report into the clipboard — handy when somebody asks for your connection details.

Ping

Type an address or a name into the **Ping** field and click **START PING**. The program pings continuously and shows the replies as they come; **STOP PING** stops it. This is a tool for watching a line over time — it makes dropping Wi-Fi and brief congestion visible.

DNS

The **DNS** list holds ready-made sets of name servers: *Automatic (DHCP)*, Google, Cloudflare, Quad9, OpenDNS and AdGuard. Pick one and click **SET DNS** **ADMIN** **PIN**.

- **Automatic (DHCP)** leaves the decision to the router — the Windows factory setting.
- **DNS TEST** checks which server answers fastest from your line. The table shows the average, best and worst time and the number of errors. **APPLY WINNER** sets the fastest one straight away, and **COPY RESULTS** puts the table into the clipboard.

A DNS change applies to the selected network card. If the computer uses a cable one day and Wi-Fi the next, set the DNS for each card separately or leave it on *Automatic*.

DISABLE NETWORK / ENABLE NETWORK

ADMIN **PIN** Switches the selected network card off and on — the equivalent of unplugging the cable by hand. Useful when the computer has to be cut off for a moment, or when the card needs to fetch a fresh address.

Careful over a remote desktop. Disabling the card you are connected through drops the session, and it cannot be restored remotely.

10. File server

The **SERVER** button opens a window that turns the computer into a simple file server. A TV, a phone or a second computer on the same network opens the address given and downloads or plays the file — with no USB stick, no cloud and nothing to install on the other side.

File server — share files on the local network

Files to share

1

update.json

2 KB

port 8890

2

HPL_IPTV_v2.15.apk

24 MB

3

D:\Films\

folder

TOTAL SIZE 24.1 MB

ADDRESS FOR TV / PLAYER

http://192.168.1.50:8080/1

☒ Allow uploading files to this PC

☐ Share on the internet (UPnP)

☒ Require a password

ADD FILES

ADD FOLDER

CLEAR LIST

COPY ADDRESS

COPY ALL ADDRESSES

QR

START SERVER

How to run it

1. Add

ADD FILES or ADD FOLDER. The list may hold several entries at once.

2. Start

START SERVER. The dot changes to *Server running*.

3. Copy the address

COPY ADDRESS, or QR to scan with a phone.

4. Open it

Type the address into a browser or a player on the other device.

Addresses — which file is where

This is the most common question when sharing several files at once. The rule is simple: **the number on the list is the number in the address.**

Address	What it returns
http://192.168.1.50:8080/	With one shared file — that file. With several — a page listing them.
http://192.168.1.50:8080/1 .../2, .../3	The file with that number on the list. The most convenient form for players and TVs.
http://192.168.1.50:8080/update.json	The file by name. Useful when the other side needs a particular name in the address — an update file, for instance.

Address	What it returns
<code>http://192.168.1.50:8080/list</code>	A page listing every shared entry, with links.
<code>http://192.168.1.50:8080/playlist.m3u</code>	An M3U playlist of all the files — opens directly in a player.
<code>http://192.168.1.50:8080/upload</code>	The page for sending files to the computer (when the option is on).

COPY ALL ADDRESSES puts the complete set of ready-made links into the clipboard, one per line — no need to assemble them by hand.

A separate port for one file

Sometimes the other side cannot append a number or a name and expects **the whole address to be one particular file**. That is what a port assigned to a list entry is for: type a port number next to a file and the program runs a separate server for it in which **every address returns that one file**.

- The port must be between **1024 and 65535**.
- One port serves one file — the program will not let the same port be used twice and says *This port is already assigned to another file*.
- **COPY PORT URL** copies the finished address in the form `http://192.168.1.50:8890/`.

This is how two different files get two different addresses: `http://192.168.1.50:8890/` and `http://192.168.1.50:8891/` — each returns its own file, whatever the client appends.

Password, UPnP and receiving files

- **Require a password** — switches on a login. Type a **USER** and a **PASSWORD** or click **GENERATE** and let the program invent them. **SHOW** reveals the password, **COPY URL WITH LOGIN** gives a ready link with the credentials inside.
- **Allow uploading files to this PC** — adds an `/upload` page through which a phone or another computer sends a file to you. The **RECEIVE FOLDER** button says where those files should land.
- **Share on the internet (UPnP)** — asks the router to let the port through from outside. The program then shows *Talking to the router...* and, if the conversation succeeds, gives the public address and can display it as a QR code.

UPnP exposes the file to the whole internet. Use it only when you really have to send something beyond the house, and **always together with a password**. When the transfer is done, stop the server with **STOP SERVER** — the forwarding then ends. Not every router has UPnP enabled; when the router refuses, the program says so plainly.

The server supports seeking. It answers range requests, so a film opened from that address in a player can be wound forwards and backwards, and an interrupted download can be resumed. Changes to the file list take effect live — adding or removing an entry needs no server restart.

The Windows firewall asks once. The first time the server starts, the system asks for permission for incoming connections. It has to be granted for **private networks**, otherwise other devices will not reach the address.

11. Network tools

NETWORK SCANNER

Goes through the whole home network and shows what is switched on in it: the IP address, the device name and the vendor of the network card recognised from the MAC address. Names come from DNS and NetBIOS, so a TV or a printer usually announces itself.

Recognised devices are saved in `ipinfo.json`, so the next scan comes back already labelled. The **+WOL** and **PORTS** buttons on a row move the device to Wake on LAN or scan its ports straight away.

CONNECTIONS

Shows **what is sending data out of this computer and where**: the local address, the remote address, the connection state and the process that opened it.

- **Find process** narrows the list down to one program name.
- **External only** hides traffic inside the computer and the local network, leaving what goes out into the world.
- **ESTABLISHED only** keeps the connections actually in place, without listening ports.
- **Check country online** adds the country and the organisation owning the address. It is the only option in this window that reaches the internet by itself — it is off by default.
- **BLOCK IN FIREWALL** **ADMIN** creates a firewall rule blocking the chosen program.

Without administrator rights some processes will appear without the path to their executable — Windows does not hand it to an ordinary user. The connection list itself works normally.

PORT SCANNER

Checks which ports are open on the given address. You can choose **common ports** or a **custom range** in the form `80,443,8000-8100`. For open ports the program tries to identify the service and shows its first reply, so you see not just “port 22 is open” but what stands behind it. A single scan is limited to 8000 ports, and **STOP** halts the work at any moment.

Scan only your own devices. Port-scanning somebody else's address is often treated as an intrusion attempt and may breach your provider's terms of service.

ROUTE (TRACEROUTE)

Shows the successive hops packets take to the given address, with their times. It makes clear whether a slowdown is at your end, at the provider's, or somewhere further down the road.

WHY IS THERE NO INTERNET?

A diagnostic that walks the connection leg by leg — the network card, the IP address, the router, DNS, the way out — and states at each stage whether it is all right. Instead of guessing you get a straight answer about the step it stopped at. **COPY REPORT** puts the result into the clipboard — ready to send to support.

TRAFFIC MONITOR

Shows the current download and upload speed for the selected card, the total since the window was opened, and a chart of **the last 60 seconds**. It answers the question “is something in the background eating the line”.

WAKE ON LAN

Wakes computers on the local network with a magic packet. A device is added once — **Name, MAC** and **IP**, the **ADD** button — and from then on **WAKE** is enough. The list is saved in `wol.json`, so it survives closing the program.

Wake on LAN has to be enabled on the other side — in the BIOS of the computer being woken and in the properties of its network card. The program only sends the packet; if the computer ignores it, the settings are over there.

WI-FI

The window shows three things at once: **the state of your own connection** (SSID, signal, channel and band, rate, security), **channel load** as a chart, and **a list of nearby networks**.

Below the chart the program names **the best free channel in the 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz bands** — a ready answer for what to set in the router when Wi-Fi slows down at peak hours. **SCAN AREA** refreshes the list, **COPY LIST** puts it into the clipboard.

When the computer has no Wi-Fi card or the WLAN service is stopped, the window says so plainly (*No Wi-Fi adapter, WLAN service is not running*) instead of showing an empty list.

CHANGE MAC

ADMIN Changes the MAC address of the selected network card. **RANDOM** generates a random private address, **CHANGE MAC** applies it and restarts the card, and **RESTORE ORIGINAL** goes back to the hardware address.

During the change the card briefly disappears from the system — the connection drops and comes back after a few seconds. If the router assigns addresses by MAC or filters access on it, the computer may get no address until you restore the original.

12. TOOLS tab

A collection of small utilities you would normally reach for separate programs for. Each button opens its own window — several can be open at once.

SCREENSHOT

Takes a shot of the whole screen and saves it into the program folder. Two settings next to the button change how it works:

- **Delay (s)** — from 0 to 60 seconds. Time to open the menu or window that should be in the shot.
- **hide program window** — HPL Tool Ultimate hides itself for the duration of the shot so it does not cover what you want to capture.
- **OPEN LAST** — opens the most recent screenshot. With none taken yet, it opens the program folder.

CLIPBOARD (HISTORY)

The program remembers what you copied and lets you go back to earlier entries — after a restart as well, because the history sits in `clipboard.json`.

- **COPY** next to an entry puts it back into the clipboard.
- **Pinning** an entry protects it from being cleared — useful for addresses, numbers and texts you use all the time.
- **CLEAR HISTORY (KEEP PINNED)** deletes everything except the pinned entries.

The clipboard history is an ordinary text file next to the program. If you copy passwords or data you would rather not leave on the disk, clear the history after work — or do not keep the program on a computer shared with others.

QUICK NOTES

A single text box that saves itself. While you type the program shows *typing...*, and after saving — *loaded*. The content lives in `notes.txt` next to the program, so it can be read and edited with an ordinary text editor. **INSERT DATE** adds the current date and time — handy when keeping a work journal.

PASSWORD GENERATOR

Generates several passwords at once. The **LENGTH** slider sets the number of characters, and the **skip look-alike characters** option removes zeros and the letter O, ones and both lower-case l and capital I, along with other characters easily confused when copied by hand. **Clicking a result copies it to the clipboard** — a *COPIED* confirmation then appears under the list.

Switch “skip look-alike characters” off for passwords you never retype by hand. The full character pool gives a stronger password. The restriction only makes sense when the password has to be dictated or copied from paper.

KEEP AWAKE

Blocks the computer from sleeping and the screen from blanking — for the duration of a long copy, render or download. Once on, the button turns violet and reads **KEEP AWAKE — ACTIVE**. Clicking again releases the block and hands control back to the Windows settings.

CLEAN TEMP

PIN Deletes temporary files from `%TEMP%` and `C:\Windows\Temp` and empties the **Recycle Bin**. The program asks for confirmation and names those three places, and when it is done reports how many files it removed and how much space it freed. Files held open by running programs are skipped — that is normal and not an error.

Emptying the Recycle Bin cannot be undone. If you rely on *Delete to Recycle Bin* elsewhere in the program as a safety net, check the Bin before running the clean-up.

CHANGE PIN

Asks for the old PIN, then for the new one. The new one is stored as a hash in `pin.dat`. Deleting that file restores the factory PIN `0000` — worth remembering when the PIN slips your mind.

13. System tools

SYSTEM REPORT

Gathers a full set of service data into one window: processor, memory, motherboard and BIOS, the system and its version, network cards, and a list of disks with their size and free space. **COPY REPORT** puts the lot into the clipboard.

This is the first thing a service desk asks for. Instead of reading values out of five system windows, send one ready report.

STARTUP MANAGER

Shows the programs launched together with Windows and lets you switch them off. Disabled entries are kept in a backup, `autostart_backup.json`, so they can be restored — the tool does not delete them for good.

Do not disable entries you do not recognise. Startup also holds audio drivers, touchpad support and graphics card software. Switch off what you know and do not need right after boot.

CHECKSUM

Computes a file's checksum — `MD5`, `SHA-1` or `SHA-256`. It is used to verify that a downloaded file is complete and identical to the publisher's.

1. **BROWSE** — pick the file. For large files the progress is visible; the computation can be stopped.
2. **COMPUTE** — the checksum appears in the **RESULT** field.
3. **COMPARE WITH** — paste the checksum the publisher gives. The program answers ✓ **MATCH** or ✗ **MISMATCH**, with no need to stare at a string of characters.

FOLDER SNAPSHOT

Answers the question “what changed in this folder”. It works in two steps: first **SAVE SNAPSHOT** records the state of the folder, and later **COMPARE WITH SNAPSHOT** shows three lists: **ADDED**, **REMOVED** and **CHANGED**.

The comparison takes the size, the date and the checksum of every file into account, so it also catches a file swapped for another of the same name and size. Reading a large folder takes time — the work can be stopped, and the program then says *Cancelled*.

Useful before and after installing an unknown program, when checking what an update changed, and when keeping an eye on a backup folder.

Windows firewall

ADMIN **PIN** Three buttons and one **Application** field in which you point at an `.exe` file with **BROWSE**:

- **BLOCK** creates a firewall rule cutting the chosen program off the network — in both directions, outbound and inbound.
- **UNBLOCK** deletes that rule.
- **RULES** shows every firewall rule present in the system.

Rules created by the program are named starting with `HPL_BLOCK_`, so they are easy to recognise and to remove from the system side as well.

DISKPART

Opens the system tool **diskpart** — the Windows console manager of disks and partitions. The program only launches it; the work itself happens in the console window, following diskpart syntax.

Diskpart works on partitions and can wipe a disk with a single command, without asking and without a Recycle Bin. Use it only when you know what command you are typing, and check the disk number twice before every operation.

Start with Windows

The **Start with Windows** box creates a shortcut in the current user's Startup folder, so the program comes up with the system. Clearing the box removes the shortcut. It is useful for shutting the computer down at a fixed hour every day — see chapter 14.

14. POWER tab

This tab plans one thing: **what to do with the computer and when**. You set two fields and click start.

POWER — scheduling

Action

• Shutdown

○ Restart

○ Hibernate

○ Sleep

○ Log off

Mode

• in X minutes [90]

○ at time [23:30]

○ daily [23:30]

Until shutdown: 01:29:58

START SHUTDOWN TIMER

CANCEL SHUTDOWN

RESTART TO BIOS

Field	Options
Action	Shutdown, Restart, Hibernate, Sleep, Log off.
Mode: in X minutes	A countdown from now. The simplest variant — “shut down in an hour and a half”.
Mode: at time	Once, at the given hour in <code>HH:MM</code> form. An hour that has already passed means the next day.
Mode: daily	Repeatedly, at the same hour every day. Together with <i>Start with Windows</i> it gives a fixed evening shutdown.

Once **START SHUTDOWN TIMER** is pressed, the clock on the top bar begins counting down. The program **announces the approaching action by voice** three minutes and one minute ahead, and again as it happens — so it will not catch you mid-work. **CANCEL SHUTDOWN** calls the plan off and the clock returns to `00:00:00`.

Closing the program needs the PIN precisely so that a scheduled shutdown does not disappear with an accidental click on the X.

RESTART TO BIOS

ADMIN **PIN** Restarts the computer straight into the UEFI settings, without catching a key at boot. It works on UEFI machines — on older ones with a classic BIOS the system offers no such option.

Save open documents before using it. The restart happens immediately after confirmation.

15. Button summary

Every button of the program in one place. **ADMIN** marks a need for administrator rights, **PIN** — a PIN prompt.

SEARCH

Button	Action
BUILD INDEX	Builds the file index from scratch for the selected scope.
REFRESH INDEX	Adds changes to the index — quicker than a rebuild.
EXCLUSIONS	The list of folders skipped while indexing.
SELECT FOLDER	Narrows the scope to one directory.
SEARCH BY NAME	Looks for a fragment in file names.
FILTER BY SIZE	Files not smaller than the given number of MB.
SEARCH BY DATE	Files from the given day or newer.
SEARCH BY EXTENSION	Files with the given extension.
COMBINED SEARCH	All filled criteria at once.
SEARCH IN CONTENT	Looks for a phrase inside text files.
FILE DUPLICATES	Groups files with the same name and size.
WHAT EATS THE DISK	Usage report: folders, extensions, biggest files.
EMPTY / 0 B	Empty folders and zero-length files.
RENAME FILES	Batch rename with a preview.
EXPORT	Saves the result list to CSV or TXT.
TO RECYCLE BIN	Moves the selected files to the Recycle Bin.
COPY TO...	Copies the selected files to a chosen folder.

NETWORK

Button	Action
MY DATA	The full connection details in one window.

Button	Action
START PING / STOP PING	Continuous ping of a chosen address.
SET DNS ADMIN PIN	Applies the chosen set of DNS servers.
DNS TEST	Measures DNS server speed and names the best.
DISABLE / ENABLE NETWORK ADMIN PIN	Switches the network card off and on.
SERVER	The file server on the local network.
NETWORK SCANNER	Devices on the network: IP, name, vendor.
PORT SCANNER	Open ports and identified services.
CONNECTIONS	Active connections and the processes behind them.
ROUTE (TRACEROUTE)	The hops on the way to an address.
WHY IS THERE NO INTERNET?	Connection diagnostics, step by step.
TRAFFIC MONITOR	Line speed and a chart of the last 60 seconds.
WAKE ON LAN	Waking computers with a magic packet.
WI-FI	Signal, channel load, nearby networks.
CHANGE MAC ADMIN	Changing and restoring the card's MAC address.

TOOLS

Button	Action
SCREENSHOT / OPEN LAST	A shot with a delay and window hiding.
CLIPBOARD (HISTORY)	History of copied texts, with pinning.
QUICK NOTES	A notepad that saves itself.
PASSWORD GENERATOR	Passwords of a given length; a click copies.
KEEP AWAKE	Blocks the computer and screen from sleeping.
CLEAN TEMP PIN	Temporary files and the Recycle Bin.
CHANGE PIN PIN	Changes the protecting code.
SYSTEM REPORT	Service data of the computer and its disks.

Button	Action
STARTUP MANAGER	Programs starting with Windows.
LOG	History of file operations, with UNDO.
CHECKSUM	MD5 / SHA-1 / SHA-256 and comparison.
FOLDER SNAPSHOT	What changed in a folder.
BLOCK / UNBLOCK / RULES ADMIN PIN	Firewall rules for a chosen program.
DISKPART ADMIN	The system partition manager.

POWER

Button	Action
START SHUTDOWN TIMER	Starts the scheduled action.
CANCEL SHUTDOWN	Calls the plan off and zeroes the clock.
RESTART TO BIOS ADMIN PIN	Restart straight into the UEFI settings.

16. Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
The activation window appears although the program was already activated.	Check that it is the same computer and that the motherboard or network card has not changed. If the hardware is the same, paste the activation code you already have — it stays valid.
“This activation code is not valid for this computer”.	Usually a code copied incompletely or broken into two parts. Copy it again in one piece. The other possibility: a code issued for a different computer.
“Index not found! Build it first”.	Click BUILD INDEX . Searching by name, size, date and extension needs the index.
Results show files that are no longer there.	The index is a snapshot of the disk. Click REFRESH INDEX .
Content search does not find a phrase from a Word document or a PDF.	That is by design — only text files are searched. The list of extensions is in chapter 6.

Symptom	What to do
The index or the settings are not being saved.	The program sits in a folder Windows does not let you write to — most often <i>Program Files</i> . Move it into a folder of your own.
“Error — run as administrator”.	The function needs elevated rights. Click RESTART AS ADMIN on the top bar.
I do not remember the PIN.	Delete the <code>pin.dat</code> file from the program folder. The PIN goes back to the factory <code>0000</code> .
The PIN does not work, the program says “Locked”.	Three wrong attempts lock the PIN for five minutes. Wait and try again.
Another device does not see the shared file.	Check that the server is running (<i>Server running</i>), that both sides are on the same network and that the Windows firewall was allowed for private networks. Take the address with COPY ADDRESS , not from memory.
The player will not seek in a film from the server.	The server supports seeking. If it does not work, the limitation is on the player's side — try the numbered address, for example <code>...:8080/1</code> .
UPnP does not work, the router does not answer.	UPnP is often disabled in the router. Switch it on in its settings or forward the port by hand. On a line with a shared address (CGNAT), sharing to the outside will not work at all.
The network scanner shows addresses without names.	Not every device announces a name. The vendor recognised from the MAC address is usually enough to identify it.
The Wi-Fi window says “No Wi-Fi adapter” or “WLAN service is not running”.	The computer has no wireless card, or the <i>WLAN AutoConfig</i> service is stopped. Start it in Windows services.
There is no connection after a MAC change.	Click RESTORE ORIGINAL . Some routers only hand out addresses to MAC addresses they know.
The scheduled shutdown did not happen.	The program has to be running at the appointed hour. For the <i>daily</i> mode, switch on Start with Windows .
The program will not close from the X.	That is by design — closing needs the PIN so that a scheduled shutdown is not cancelled by accident.
The antivirus reports an unknown file.	The program is packed into a single .exe and carries no publisher signature, so it is sometimes reported as unknown. Verify the checksum of the file you received and add it to the exceptions.